

## SIMPLE BUT EFFECTIVE FIREARM

## MATCHLOCK MUSKET

The invention of the matchlock *hackenbüsche*, or arquebus, cannot be dated precisely, but evidence points to it being around 1475, of German origin. Its source of ignition was a length of smouldering “match” – cord soaked in saltpetre. On pulling the trigger, the match, held in a

pivoting holder, swung down and touched off a small quantity of priming powder held in a pan, which lit the main gunpowder charge via a narrow touch-hole. Matchlocks were superseded by flintlocks in the early 1600s, but were still used until the end of that century, due to their simplicity and low cost.

## ► MATCHLOCK MUSKET

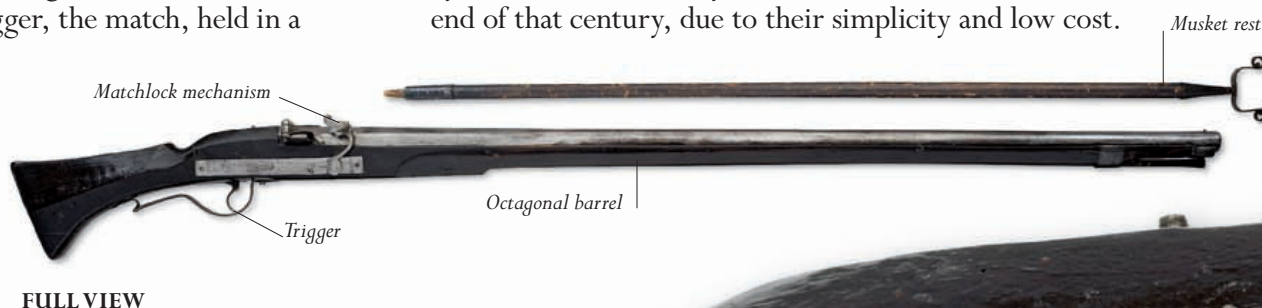
**Date** Mid-17th century

**Origin** Britain

**Weight** 6.05kg (13¼lb)

**Barrel** 126cm (49½in)

**Calibre** .75in



FULL VIEW



## ▲ MATCHLOCK MUSKET

While the matchlock was a significant improvement over the hand-cannon, it was still a very clumsy weapon. Early examples were unwieldy and not very accurate. Even in dry weather the match could be extinguished all too easily, and its glowing end was a giveaway at night.

## ► BANDOLIER

This “collar of charges”, worn diagonally over the shoulder, carried around 12 wooden flasks, each of which held a measure of powder for one shot.



Wooden flask